NEW RECIPE · THE CURLY CHEF

Eggless Dark Marble Cookies

One base dough split into vanilla and chocolate halves, then torn and twisted back together — the marble is born in a single tear-and-restack. Crackled tops, chewy centres, completely eggless.

YIELD	BAKE	PORTION
12 large cookies	175°C / 165°C fan, 11–13 min	~55 g each

Ingredients — base dough

Unsalted butter, softened	**115 g**
Light brown sugar	**110 g**
Caster sugar	**60 g**
Full-fat Greek yoghurt (thick)	**50 g**
Vanilla bean paste	**5 g**
Whole milk	**15 ml**
Plain flour	**250 g**
Cornflour	**20 g**
Baking soda	**3 g**
Fine sea salt	**3 g**

Ingredients — chocolate half

Dutch-process cocoa powder	**30 g**
Extra whole milk	**20 ml**

Method

1. **Cream.** Beat the butter with both sugars 3–4 minutes until pale, fluffy and aerated.
2. **Wet base.** Beat in the yoghurt, vanilla and 15 ml milk until completely smooth — no lumps.
3. **Sift & fold.** Sift the flour, cornflour, baking soda and salt together; fold into the wet base just until no dry flour remains.
4. **Split.** Divide the dough into two equal halves — weigh it, ~340 g each, so the marble is even.
5. **Chocolate half.** Sift the cocoa over one half, add the extra 20 ml milk, and fold until it is a uniform deep-dark dough. Keep the other half plain vanilla. This is the foolproof trick: one base dough, split at the end — no separate chocolate recipe to balance.
6. **Marble.** Divide each half into 12 portions (~24 g each). For each cookie, press one vanilla and one chocolate portion together, roll into a ball, then tear it in half and press back together once — that single tear-and-restack is what forms the marble. **Do not overwork** — two folds maximum, or the marble muddies.
7. **Chill.** Refrigerate the marbled balls 45–60 minutes until firm.
8. **Bake** at 175°C / 165°C fan for 11–13 minutes. Edges set, tops crackled, centres still soft and puffy — pull them while the centres look slightly underdone; they finish as they cool.
9. **Rest.** 10 minutes on the tray (they set), then move to a rack.

Curly Chef notes

- **Why it can’t fail:** single base dough split at step 4 — nothing to re-balance; cocoa + extra milk keeps the chocolate half exactly as soft as the vanilla half, so both bake identically; the chill controls spread; the underbake guarantees chewy centres.
- **Don’t skip the weigh-and-split** — equal halves give an even marble; eyeballing gives one muddy cookie.
- **Dutch cocoa, not natural** — darker colour, deeper flavour, and the marble contrast pops.
- **Storage:** airtight at room temperature, 4–5 days. They stay chewy to day 3.

Curly Chef standard: eggless · dark marble · brown sugar